

01 COHORT STRATEGY

THE QUESTION

Which users do we build around, and why? What data point(s) will tell us the answer?

WHY IT MATTERS

Often, we go into a launch with an aspirational target audience. The mistake is confusing aspiration with reality. The users who actually love the product and stick around are often not who we expected. And if we ignore them in favor of chasing a customer who was never going to come or stay, we don't have a business.

THE TAKEAWAY

Go in with intention, but data will tell us who our real customer is. Then, build around them. The key is in identifying the right data point (hint: it's usually not volume of customers from "XYZ channel").

02 POSITIONING

THE QUESTION

What we believe makes us special and what our audience believes are often not the same thing. **The unlock is the simple truth that connects them.**

WHY IT MATTERS

It's easy to get close to the product and start leading with *what excites us*: the technology, the model, the proprietary architecture. The audience often does not care what we think is cool. They have one thing on their mind when deciding whether to try something new, and it is almost always simpler than anyone inside the company expects.

THE TAKEAWAY

Strip out the internal narrative. Find the simple truth that the audience wants to believe and show them how our product delivers it.

03 ACTIVATION SEQUENCING

THE QUESTION

What do we need to learn before we scale? What are the gates that unlock our next move?

WHY IT MATTERS

Sequencing is not a channel rollout. It is a learning agenda. The question is not which campaigns or channels go live first - it is what we need to know first, and what is the sharpest experiment that gets us that answer. Each inflection point unlocks the next decision.

THE TAKEAWAY

It's easy to default to sequencing tactics. Don't. Sequence the learning agenda instead. Build gates, e.g. the inflection points. where what we've learned unlocks what we do next.

04 RETENTION

THE QUESTION

Do we need to optimize for volume or depth? Which one actually funds our next round?

WHY IT MATTERS

We often treat retention as something to fix after growth. We shouldn't. Investors will want to know how sticky our customers are, and CAC is usually secondary because if customers stay and use the product deeply, a higher acquisition cost is manageable. If they churn, no growth strategy fixes the business. Retention.

THE TAKEAWAY

Optimize for depth before optimizing for volume (or, both in parallel). The customers who stay and invite others are often the reason the next round gets funded.